

International organizations

This listing provides acronym definitions for the main international organizations concerned with worldwide economics, trade, and defense, plus an indication of membership.

ASEAN

Association of Southeast Asian Nations

ESTABLISHED: 1967

MEMBERS: Brunei, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, Vietnam

CIS

Commonwealth of Independent States

ESTABLISHED: 1991

MEMBERS: Arm., Az., Belarus, Kaz., Kyrgy., Mold., Russia, Tajik., Turkmen.*, Ukraine*, Uzbek. *Unofficial members

COMM *The Commonwealth of Nations*

ESTABLISHED: 1931; evolved out of the British Empire. Formerly known as the British Commonwealth of Nations.

MEMBERS: 53

EU *European Union*

ESTABLISHED: 1965; formerly known as EEC (European Economic Community) and EC (Economic Community)

MEMBERS: Austria, Belg., Bulg., Cyprus, Czech Rep., Denmark, Est., Fin., Fr., Ger., Greece, Hung., Ireland, Italy, Lat., Lith., Lux., Malta, Neth., Pol., Port., Rom., Slvka., Slvna., Spain, Swed., UK

G8 *Group of 8*

ESTABLISHED: 1994

MEMBERS: Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, Russia, UK, US

IMF *International Monetary Fund* (UN agency)

ESTABLISHED: 1945

MEMBERS: 186

NAFTA

North American Free Trade Agreement

ESTABLISHED: 1994

MEMBERS: Canada, Mexico, US

NATO

North Atlantic Treaty Organization

ESTABLISHED: 1949

MEMBERS: Albania, Belg., Bulg., Canada, Croatia, Czech Rep., Denmark, Est., France, Ger., Greece, Hung., Iceland, Italy, Lat., Lith., Lux., Neth., Norway, Poland, Port., Rom., Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Turkey, UK, US

OPEC *Organization of Petroleum* *Exporting Countries*

ESTABLISHED: 1960

MEMBERS: Algeria, Angola, Ecuador, Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Libya, Nigeria, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, United Arab Emirates, Venezuela

UN *United Nations*

ESTABLISHED: 1945

MEMBERS: 192; all nations are represented, except Taiwan. The Vatican City has "observer status" only.

WTO *World Trade Organization*

ESTABLISHED: 1995

MEMBERS: 153